

Post-incident review PIR-2026-029

Search Service: elevated error rates

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 09 July 2026, Search Service experienced elevated error rates in production (US West) for about 110 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that the client certificate used for the partner integration was not renewed.

Impact

Users of Search Service saw elevated error rates for about 110 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:19 First signal received.
- 09:29 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:55 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:58 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the client certificate used for the partner integration was not renewed.

No dependency outages were reported by upstream providers during the window.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.